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Blog

Solar, Smart Home Partnerships List adds Solar City and Nest

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In the latest of a long string of solar companies and smart home component companies coming together for the benefit of consumers, Solar City and Nest have now partnered. This move is not unprecedented, but the names involved certainly attract news.

When such heavy hitters in American ingenuity like Solar City Chairman Elon Musk of Tesla and SpaceX, Nest co-founder Tony Fadell of Apple's iPod design team are involved in a partnership, people tend to pay attention.

The partnership brings together two of the biggest names in tech to advance the cause of reduced energy consumption in the home. Recently, Solar City, which is quickly becoming synonymous with home solar panel installs, announced it will offer 10,000 Nest thermostats to California customers.

The goal of this partnership is to give home owners further control over their energy creation and consumption. This news comes after a banner year for Nest, after getting acquired by Google the smart thermostat company reported that its customers used 55 percent less (<http://bit.ly/1Gc-SyJ0>) air conditioning on average.

The partnership doesn't stop with handing over an added piece of tech to customers. Solar City intends to "offer 'seasonal savings' to customers by slightly adjusting temperatures over the course of a few weeks during shoulder seasons," reports (<http://bit.ly/1F7mlfp>) GreenTech Media. This process will help teach the thermostat how to remain more efficient during peak heating and cooling periods in the winter and summer.

As one might have guessed, this will all come with a companion app. MySolarCity app will assist customers with visualizations and statistical data of their energy consumption in real time.

Rumors and speculation are pointing to an ever expanding offering from SolarCity. Elon Musk recently teased a new product from Tesla that many are expecting to be a home battery, similar to those found on the Tesla Model S but larger and used to store energy created by rooftop solar PV panels.

Musk has not officially announced his plans for that product, but the rumors do coincide with the completion of Tesla and Panasonic's joint venture, the Gigafactory battery manufacturing plant currently under construction (<http://bit.ly/1H8njiA>) in Nevada.

Given the growing strength of the home installed PV solar panel market, these partnerships will likely help drive adoption and eventually drive down upfront costs across the board.

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